THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS

[Course Code] [Course Title]
Government and Regulation

GENERAL INFORMATION

Instructor: Prof./ Dr. Ruixue Jia

Email: [ ]@hku.hk
Office: KK [ ]
Phone: 3917 [ ]
Consultation times: TBD

Tutor: TBD

Pre-requisites: **[ECON6074]**
Co-requisites: [ ]
Mutually exclusive: [ ]

Course Website: TBD
Reference Book:
[Book]
The following programming languages are used in this course: [programing language]
[Software] is also used.

COURSE DESCRIPTION

We live in a world shaped by regulation: the air we breathe, the water we drink, the food we eat, the cars we drive, the homes we live in, and the schools we attend are all influenced by government oversight. But why do governments regulate? Do we have too much or too little regulation? And how does regulation impact economic development—does it foster growth or create barriers? This course aims to explore these questions while equipping you with analytical tools to evaluate them critically. The course is structured into two parts:

- **Theoretical Foundations of Government and Regulation**
- **Applications in the Political Economy of Regulation**: This section will examine contentious topics such as industrial policy, data governance, and social mobility.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

This course aims to:

- Introduce students to the core **theories of government and regulation**, including public interest theory, capture theory, market failure, government failure, and state capacity.
- Examine **why, when, and how governments regulate**, and whether regulation fosters or hinders economic development.
- Apply these theoretical frameworks to **contemporary policy debates**, including environmental regulation, media, industrial policy, data governance, gender inequality, social mobility, and political polarization.
- Equip students with the **analytical and empirical tools** needed to evaluate regulatory policies critically, including the ability to read, interpret, and assess empirical research in political economy.
- Develop students' ability to **communicate research findings** effectively through structured presentations.

PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Have a good knowledge of the major theories and applications related to governments and regulation
- Be able to recognize the most important results in empirical papers and interpret them
- Be able to design a research project to study government regulations.

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Course Learning Outcomes	Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes
CLO1: [Have a good knowledge of the major theories and applications related to governments and regulation]	PLO[ ]
	PLO[ ]
CLO2: [Be able to recognize the most important results in empirical papers and interpret them]	PLO[ ]
	PLO[ ]
CLO3: [Be able to design a research project to study government regulations]	

COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Course Teaching and Learning Activities	Expected Hour	Study Load (% of study)
<<examples>>		
T&L1. Interactive lectures	30	25%
T&L2. Assignments & Presentations	50	42%
T&L3. Lecture preparation & Self-study	40	33%
Total	[should range from 120 to 150]	100%

Assessment Methods	Brief Description (Optional)	Weight	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
A1. Self-introduction	Effort and accuracy	5%	
A2. In-class participation	Attendance and participation	30%	CLO1, 2, 3
A3. Team presentation	Effort and accuracy	35%	CLO1, 2, 3
A4. Final project	Creativity	30%	CLO1, 2, 3
	Total	100%	

STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT

Course Grade Descriptors	
A+, A, A-	・Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge ・Handling questions professionally ・High participation in discussions ・Present arguments that have an element of originality ・Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the exams with very accurate computation and very good analytical and problem solving skills ・Excellent performance in assignments

B+, B, B-	• Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions in a logical way • Good participation in discussions • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook • Achieve a standard of good performance in the exams with accurate computation and good analytical and problem solving skills • Good performance in assignments
C+, C, C-	• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Fairly address questions as set • Some participation in discussions • Present arguments in a well-structure manner • Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the exams with reasonably accurate computation and acceptable analytical and problem solving skills • Acceptable performance in assignments
D+, D	• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Barely address questions as set • Minimal or no participation in discussions • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the exams with some errors in computation and barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills • Marginally acceptable performance in assignments
F	• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Unable or unwilling to handle questions • Minimal or no participation in discussions • Present arguments poorly • Fail to meet a standard of passing the exams with major errors in computation and inadequate analytical and problem solving skills • Poorly performance in assignments
Assessment Rubrics for Participation	
A+, A, A-	• High participation in discussions • Always attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions professionally • Present arguments that have an element of originality • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
B+, B, B-	• Good participation in discussions • Often attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions in a logical way • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
C+, C, C-	• Some participation in discussions • Sometimes attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Fairly address questions as set • Present arguments in a well-structure manner • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
D+, D	• Minimal or no participation in discussions • Rarely attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Barely address questions as set • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
F	• Minimal or no participation in discussions • Almost never attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Unable or unwilling to handle questions • Present arguments poorly • Behave poorly in class (often chatting with others, using cell phones, or being late)

Assessment Rubrics for Assignments and the Exam

A+, A, A-	• Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Present arguments that have an element of originality • Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the assessments with very accurate computation and very good analytical and problem solving skills
B+, B, B-	• Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook • Achieve a standard of good performance in the assessments with accurate computation and good analytical and problem solving skills
C+, C, C-	• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments in a well-structure manner • Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the assessments with reasonably accurate computation and acceptable analytical and problem solving skills
D+, D	• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the assessments with some errors in computation and barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills
F	• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments poorly • Fail to meet a standard of passing the assessments with major errors in computation and inadequate analytical and problem solving skills

COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE

[ ] M5: Tuesday & Friday

REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS (e.g. journals, textbooks, website addresses etc.)

To be announced on Moodle.

MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

○ Online response via Moodle site

○ Others: ___SFTL_____ (please specify)

COURSE POLICY (e.g. plagiarism, academic honesty, attendance, etc.)

An orderly learning environment is extremely important for this course. Disruptive behaviors are absolutely unacceptable. Academic dishonesty includes cheating, plagiarism, unauthorized collaboration, falsifying academic records, and any act designed to avoid participating honestly in the learning process. Any such dishonesty will result in an F grade.

ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION (e.g. e-learning platforms & materials, penalty for late assignments, etc.)

Assignments will be submitted in class before the lectures. No late assignment will be accepted.
Lecture notes and self-learning materials will be uploaded on Moodle.
Good questions and discussions on Moodle will be awarded participation grades.